

Opener Spoiled by Rain and Miller

By LESTER KOELLING

Some good news emanated today from rain-drenched Victory Field where even ducks would have been uncomfortable in last night's rain-shortened American Association baseball opener.

Offsetting such an unfortunate event as the Tribe's 1-0 loss to Minneapolis was the announcement that the Indianapolis management has signed Sam Mele, veteran major leaguer, as a free agent. The outfielder - first baseman who spent 10 years in the American and National leagues, recently was cut loose by the Cleveland Indians.

The 34-year-old Mele was expected to join Indianapolis today and Manager Andy Cohen said "if he's in shape and ready to play he'll be in the lineup tonight." Weather permitting, the Indians and Millers will meet again at 7:45 with Al Papai on the mound for the Tribe and Al Corwin hurling for the Millers.

Mele is counted on to give the Indians the right-handed power they need from outfielders. The veteran, who is a nephew of Tony Cuccinello, Chicago White Sox coach and former Indianapolis coach, hit the majors in 1947 with Boston. Later stops included Washington, Chicago, Baltimore, Cincinnati and Cleveland, where he batted .254 in 57 games last year.

As things turned out last night, it would have been better not to have started the game. Not only were the Indians held scoreless in the six innings of play, they didn't even get a hit off Stu Miller, whose pitches were coming to the plate slower than the rain was falling. Only two batters reached base, Ted Beard drawing a walk in the first inning and Don Prohovich getting a pass in the fifth.

Whether to start the game or postpone was the tough problem confronting Tribe officials. The final decision was made by Manager Cohen, who said:

"It looked like the skies were clearing early in the evening and when the airport weather station told us that we would have a better chance of getting the game in tonight than tomorrow night, we decided to go ahead. That's the last time I'll believe a weatherman."

It was drizzling when the game started and raining steadily during the fifth and sixth innings. Then the umpires were on the spot. But they had no choice but to call time at the end of six innings. After a wait of 50 minutes, officially called the game with rain still peppering down and only a few of the 3,347 game-time fans remaining.

LATMAN ALLOWS BUT FOUR HITS

From an Indianapolis standpoint, one could only applaud the work of Barry Latman, the young right-hander who seems certain of becoming a favorite with Victory Field patrons. Fastballing, Latman yielded only four hits, three walks and fanned five in his first start in a season opener.

But one of the Minneapolis hits—on the only really bad pitch made by Latman—cost him the game. Carlos Paula hopped on a high-hanging curve ball for a double in the first

3 Indiana Teams in Midwest Loop Again

MICHIGAN CITY, Ind. (AP)

—Michigan City, Kokomo and Lafayette again will field baseball teams in the Class D Midwest League this season. Michigan City's White Caps had threatened to drop the franchise in a dispute with the city park board over revenue, but an agreement was reached Tuesday.



Mele

TRIBE BOX SCORE

MINNEAPOLIS (1)

	AB	R	H	D	A	E
Bressard, W	2	1	0	0	1	0
Terwilliger, 2b	1	1	0	1	1	0
Thompson, H	2	0	0	1	0	0
Paula, cf	3	0	0	2	0	0
Cepeda, 1b	2	0	0	0	0	0
Covensand, 3b	2	0	1	0	0	0
Alou, cf	2	0	0	2	0	0
Jackson, c	2	0	1	0	0	0
Miller, p	1	0	0	0	4	0
Total	21	3	1	4	18	5

INDIANAPOLIS (0)

	AB	R	H	D	A	E
Means, H	2	0	0	1	0	0
Garcia, 2b	1	0	0	2	1	0
Beard, cf	1	0	0	1	0	0
Jackson, 1b	0	0	0	3	0	0
Prohovich, 3b	1	0	0	1	2	0
Deising, cf	0	0	0	2	0	0
Barnes, c	2	0	0	0	0	0
Williams, 2b	2	0	0	0	1	0
Latman, p	2	0	0	0	0	0
Total	18	0	0	18	5	1

Minneapolis .. 100 000-1
Indianapolis .. 000 000-0 (Called: Rain)

Run batted in—Paula. Two-base hit—Paula. Slain base—Paula. Sacrifice—Terwilliger. Double play—Williams to Garcia to Jackson. Left on base—Minneapolis 6, Indianapolis 2.

PITCHING SUMMARY

	P	H	R	E	R	B	S	O	WP
Miller	6	0	0	0	2	7	0		
Latman	4	4	1	1	3	5	0		
Umpires	Dryle, Kinsman and Van Kester.	Time—1:55.	Attendance—3,347.						



Wrong Key

Manager Andy Cohen received a key to the city from Mayor Phil Bay before last night's season baseball opener, but a key to victory would have been more useful. Cohen's 1957 Indians lost their first game, 1-0 in six innings, to Minneapolis and also failed to get a hit off Stu Miller in the rain-drenched contest. The News Photo—Bob Doeppers.

inning, scoring Wayne Terwilliger, who had walked. Ironically, the Indianapolis management missed acquiring Paula from Washington by a day. He was sold to Minneapolis the day before Tribe President Owain Bush was advised that Washington was peddling the outfielder.

Latman turned in a dazzling pitching performance in the third after the Millers loaded the bases with none out. On six successive swinging strikes, he retired Hank Thompson and Paula. Then came two more swinging strikes by Felipe Cepeda before Latman missed the plate with another fast ball. Cepeda finally forced a runner at second.

Latman and Manager Cohen took the defeat philosophically. They were inclined to give all due credit to Miller, who "pitched a smart game and completely baffled our hitters." Latman recalled losing four consecutive one-run decisions at Memphis last season, and added "I hope this isn't the start of another string."

